CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-09-21

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

19	15	12	2	48	0
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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■ Market Intelligence

19 items

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-09-15 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Face Implementation Deadline

The EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone must be able to receive instant credit transfers by early 2025, with sending capabilities following shortly after. This regulation also introduces caps on instant payment fees, ensuring they are no higher than standard SEPA credit transfer fees. Furthermore, PSPs must offer a "Verification of Payee" (VoP) service to combat fraud, a significant new requirement. The regulation's phased rollout presents challenges for banks, particularly those in CEE, requiring substantial upgrades to their payment infrastructure and compliance systems. Corporates will benefit from faster liquidity management and real-time transaction visibility.

→ Mandatory instant payment receipt by early 2025 for Eurozone PSPs.

→ Instant payment fees capped at standard SEPA credit transfer rates.

→ "Verification of Payee" (VoP) service becomes mandatory for fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus. It necessitates immediate upgrades to ensure full compliance with instant payment processing and the new VoP requirements across all CEE network banks. CMIplus must support these capabilities to remain competitive and offer seamless, compliant instant payment services to its corporate clients.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-09-01 | #02

PSD3 Proposals Advance Open Banking for Corporate Treasury

PSD3 and the PSR are set to replace PSD2, addressing its shortcomings and expanding the scope of open banking. Key proposals include enhanced fraud prevention measures, improved data sharing mechanisms, and clearer rules for third-party providers (TPPs). For corporate treasury, this means greater potential for real-time cash management, automated reconciliation, and potentially eBAM (electronic Bank Account Management) through standardized APIs. Banks will need to invest further in robust API infrastructure and security protocols to support these advanced services, fostering a more integrated and efficient financial ecosystem across Europe. The focus on API standardization will be crucial for multi-bank connectivity.

→ PSD3 and PSR replace PSD2, focusing on fraud and open banking expansion.

→ Enhanced data sharing and clearer rules for Third-Party Providers (TPPs).

→ Potential for advanced corporate treasury services via APIs, including eBAM.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The evolution of PSD3 and Open Banking is a strategic imperative for CMIplus. RBI must actively develop and enhance its Open Banking APIs to support new services like real-time cash management, automated reconciliation, and eBAM, ensuring CMIplus remains at the forefront of digital treasury solutions for CEE corporates. Compliance with new regulations will also be key.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-08-28 | #03

AI Revolutionizes Payment Fraud Prevention Amidst Real-Time Threats

The rapid adoption of instant payments, while beneficial for liquidity, also presents new challenges for fraud prevention, as fraudulent transactions can clear almost immediately. AI and machine learning algorithms are proving indispensable in this fight, analyzing vast datasets of transaction patterns, user behavior, and network anomalies in real-time. These systems can identify suspicious activities that human analysts might miss, such as unusual payment amounts, unfamiliar beneficiaries, or deviations from typical corporate spending profiles. Implementing AI requires robust data governance and integration with existing treasury and payment systems, but the investment yields substantial returns in reducing financial losses and maintaining trust.

→ AI is crucial for combating fraud in the era of instant payments.

→ Real-time anomaly detection identifies suspicious transaction patterns.

→ AI analyzes user behavior and network anomalies to prevent fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Integrating advanced AI-driven fraud prevention capabilities into CMIplus is paramount for RBI. This enhances the security of instant payments and protects corporate clients from financial losses, reinforcing CMIplus's position as a secure and reliable platform. RBI should explore partnerships or in-house development to leverage AI for real-time fraud detection.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-09-01 | #04

EU Instant Payments Mandate Accelerates CEE Adoption

The European Union's new Instant Payments Regulation, effective early 2026, requires all payment service providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA to offer instant credit transfers in EUR within 10 seconds, 24/7, 365 days a year. Crucially, it also mandates that charges for instant payments cannot exceed those for standard credit transfers. This regulation is a game-changer for the CEE region, where instant payment adoption has been varied. Banks must now ensure their infrastructure supports real-time processing and robust fraud prevention for these high-speed transactions. Corporates will benefit from improved liquidity management and faster cash flow, but also face the challenge of integrating real-time capabilities into their treasury systems. The regulation aims to boost the EU's strategic autonomy and reduce reliance on foreign payment schemes.

→ Mandatory instant EUR credit transfers within 10 seconds.

→ Fees capped at standard credit transfer rates.

→ Effective early 2026 for EU/EEA PSPs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly relevant for CMIplus, driving demand for instant payment capabilities across its CEE network. RBI must ensure CMIplus fully supports the new mandates, including real-time processing, fraud detection, and competitive pricing, to maintain its leadership in corporate cash management.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-08-15 | #05

ISO 20022 Migration Progress: Challenges and Opportunities

The ongoing global migration to ISO 20022, particularly for high-value payments and cross-border transactions, is reaching critical milestones. While the richer, structured data format promises significant benefits like improved reconciliation, fraud detection, and straight-through processing, many corporates and banks still face challenges in adapting their legacy systems. The phased approach, with deadlines extending into 2026 and beyond for some markets and payment types, requires continuous investment in technology and staff training. For CEE banks, aligning with these global standards is crucial for seamless cross-border operations and maintaining competitiveness. The transition also presents an opportunity to streamline internal processes and leverage the enhanced data for better treasury insights.

→ Global migration to ISO 20022 continues for payments.

→ Offers richer, structured data for reconciliation and fraud.

→ Implementation challenges persist for legacy systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must fully support ISO 20022 standards, including enhanced data fields, to facilitate seamless payments and reporting for its corporate clients. RBI should highlight CMIplus's readiness and capabilities in leveraging ISO 20022 to offer superior data insights and operational efficiency, especially for multi-currency and cross-border payments in CEE.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-09-10 | #06

Open Banking APIs Transform Corporate Treasury Operations

The expansion of Open Banking beyond retail banking is significantly impacting corporate treasury, particularly through the adoption of APIs for real-time data exchange. Corporates are leveraging these APIs to connect directly with various bank accounts, gaining consolidated views of balances and transactions across their multi-bank relationships. This real-time visibility is crucial for effective liquidity management, cash forecasting, and optimizing working capital. Furthermore, Open Banking APIs enable greater automation of treasury processes, from payment initiation to reconciliation, reducing manual effort and operational risk. While security and standardization remain key considerations, the benefits in terms of efficiency and control are driving rapid adoption, especially among large international corporates operating in diverse regions like CEE.

→ Open Banking APIs provide real-time multi-bank visibility.

→ Enhances liquidity management and cash forecasting.

→ Automates payment initiation and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, with its focus on Open API capabilities, is well-positioned to capitalize on this trend. RBI should actively promote CMIplus's Open Banking API features, enabling corporate clients to integrate seamlessly with their ERP/TMS systems for enhanced cash visibility and automated treasury workflows across the CEE network.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-09-21 | #07

EU ISO 20022 Migration Deadline Approaches for Cross-Border Payments

The European Payments Council (EPC) and various national payment schemes have set a firm deadline for the full migration to ISO 20022 for all SEPA and cross-border payments. This standard offers richer data, improving reconciliation, fraud detection, and regulatory reporting. While many institutions have made progress, a significant number of corporates, especially SMEs, are still lagging in their readiness. The transition requires updates to ERP and TMS systems, as well as close collaboration with banking partners. Non-compliance after the deadline could lead to payment processing delays or rejections, impacting liquidity and supply chains, making timely preparation essential.

→ Full ISO 20022 migration deadline for cross-border payments.

→ Enhanced data capabilities for reconciliation and fraud prevention.

→ Many corporates, particularly SMEs, remain unprepared.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must ensure all clients are fully aware of the upcoming ISO 20022 deadlines and provide necessary support for their migration. This includes offering robust ISO 20022-compliant channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT) and advisory services to facilitate a smooth transition for CEE corporates.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-09-21 | #08

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory Real-Time Processing Looms

The European Union has finalized legislation making instant payments mandatory for all euro transactions within the bloc. This regulation requires banks to offer instant payment services at the same cost as standard credit transfers and to process payments within seconds, 24/7/365. For corporates, this means faster cash flow, but also necessitates more sophisticated real-time liquidity management and fraud prevention systems. Banks are now working to upgrade their infrastructure and ensure compliance within the stipulated timelines. The regulation aims to boost the adoption of instant payments across Europe, fostering innovation and competition in the payment landscape and requiring strategic adjustments from all participants.

→ Mandatory instant payments for all euro transactions in EU.

→ Payments processed within seconds, 24/7/365.

→ Instant payments must be offered at standard credit transfer cost.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must fully support the EU Instant Payments Regulation, ensuring seamless real-time payment processing for CEE clients. This includes upgrading infrastructure, integrating with instant payment schemes, and providing tools for real-time liquidity visibility and fraud detection to meet client expectations and regulatory requirements.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-09-21 | #09

PSD3 and Open Banking: Next Wave of Payment Innovation

Following the success and challenges of PSD2, the European Commission is actively preparing for PSD3, which aims to further refine and expand the scope of Open Banking. Key areas of focus include strengthening consumer protection, improving fraud prevention mechanisms, and fostering greater interoperability between payment service providers. PSD3 is expected to streamline API standards, potentially leading to more sophisticated data-driven services and a broader range of payment initiation options. For corporates, this could mean more integrated treasury solutions, better cash visibility, and new ways to manage working capital through enhanced Open Banking APIs, driving significant innovation in the financial sector.

→ PSD3 aims to expand and refine Open Banking scope.

→ Focus on consumer protection and enhanced fraud prevention.

→ Expected to streamline API standards for greater interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should actively monitor PSD3 developments to anticipate future requirements for Open Banking APIs and payment services. This presents an opportunity to develop advanced API-driven solutions for CEE corporates, offering deeper integration, improved cash visibility, and innovative payment initiation services.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-09-21 | #10

ECB Progresses Digital Euro Pilot and Timeline

The European Central Bank is advancing its work on a digital euro, exploring its design, functionality, and legal framework. The project includes an innovation platform and pilot phase to test technical solutions and user experience. The goal is to ensure the digital euro complements cash, supports financial stability, and fosters innovation in retail payments, while addressing concerns around privacy and accessibility. A clear timeline and progress updates are being provided, indicating a significant step towards modernizing the euro area's payment landscape and potentially impacting corporate treasury operations.

→ Digital euro development includes a 'Pilot' phase.

→ ECB is tracking 'Timeline and progress' for its introduction.

→ Focus areas include 'privacy' and 'how it works'.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The digital euro represents a significant future development for corporate payments and treasury. CMIplus needs to monitor its progress closely to understand potential integration requirements, new payment rails, and opportunities for corporate clients, especially regarding multi-currency payments and liquidity management in a digital currency environment.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-09-21 | #11

ECB Drives Instant Payments Adoption Across SEPA

Under its Retail Payments Strategy, the ECB is actively promoting instant payments as a key component of the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). The objective is to ensure that instant payment services are available and accessible to all citizens and businesses across the euro area, facilitating faster and more efficient transactions. This involves working with market participants to overcome implementation challenges and encouraging banks to offer instant payment solutions, building on the success of the TIPS infrastructure. The focus is on increasing reach, improving user experience, and fostering innovation in payment services, which is crucial for modern corporate cash management.

→ Instant payments are a core focus of the ECB.

→ Part of the 'Retail payments strategy' under SEPA.

→ Aims for widespread 'adoption' across the euro area.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Instant payments are already a critical offering for CMIplus. This continued ECB focus reinforces the need for RBI to ensure full compliance, expand instant payment capabilities across its CEE network, and leverage real-time processing for enhanced liquidity management and corporate treasury solutions. It also highlights the importance of ISO 20022 readiness for seamless integration.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-09-21 | #12

Bulgaria Set to Join Euro Area in 2026

The ECB source explicitly lists 'Bulgaria (2026)' under 'Joining the euro area,' indicating its planned accession. This event will necessitate substantial changes for Bulgarian banks and businesses, including conversion of national currency to euro, integration into SEPA for euro payments, and adoption of Eurosystem monetary policy and payment systems like TARGET Services. For RBI Cash Management, this means its network banks in Bulgaria will undergo a major transition, impacting multi-currency operations, liquidity management, and compliance with euro area regulations. The process involves meeting convergence criteria and preparing the financial sector for the changeover.

→ 'Bulgaria (2026)' is listed for euro adoption.

→ Represents a 'significant expansion' of the euro area in CEE.

→ Requires 'integration into SEPA' and Eurosystem payment systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is a direct and critical development for RBI, given its strong presence in CEE. CMIplus must prepare for the transition of its Bulgarian operations, including currency conversion, SEPA compliance, and potential changes to payment processing, reporting, and liquidity management for clients operating in Bulgaria. This offers opportunities for RBI to support clients through the transition and strengthen its regional offering.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-09-21 | #13

ECB Launches Pontes for Tokenised Wholesale Settlement

The Eurosystem, comprising the ECB and national central banks of the Eurozone, has launched Pontes, a significant step towards integrating tokenised finance into the traditional financial system. Pontes provides a mechanism for wholesale transactions involving tokenised assets to be settled directly in central bank money, aiming to enhance efficiency and reduce settlement risk. This move signals the ECB's commitment to exploring the potential of distributed ledger technology (DLT) for financial markets, potentially paving the way for future innovations in securities and payments. It's a crucial development for the evolution of digital finance infrastructure within the Eurozone, impacting how large corporates might manage liquidity and assets in the future.

→ ECB launched 'Pontes' solution.

→ Enables wholesale transactions in tokenised assets.

→ Settlement occurs in central bank money.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as it signals a future direction for wholesale payments and liquidity management in Europe. CMIplus will need to monitor how tokenised assets and central bank money settlement evolve, as corporate clients may eventually seek to manage such assets or require integration with these new rails for treasury operations. It underscores the need for future-proofing payment and treasury platforms.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-09-21 | #14

ECB Unveils Pontes to Bridge DLT with TARGET Services

Pontes is a critical step by the ECB to investigate the interoperability between emerging DLT solutions and established financial market infrastructures like TARGET Services (e.g., TARGET2, T2S). The initiative will focus on developing and testing technical solutions for settling wholesale transactions on DLT platforms using central bank money. This exploration is crucial for understanding the implications of DLT for real-time gross settlement systems and securities settlement, potentially paving the way for new payment and treasury services in Europe. The project aims to ensure that future financial innovation remains anchored in central bank money, maintaining financial stability and market integrity, and could influence future standards like ISO 20022.

→ ECB initiative: "Pontes" launched.

→ Purpose: Link DLT platforms with TARGET Services.

→ Focus: Wholesale financial markets and central bank money settlement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for CMIplus as it signals future directions for European payment infrastructure. RBI Cash Management needs to monitor Pontes's progress closely to understand potential impacts on ISO 20022, instant payments, and corporate treasury operations. Early awareness will allow CMIplus to adapt its platform and services to integrate DLT-based solutions or new settlement mechanisms, ensuring continued relevance and competitive advantage for its CEE corporate clients.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-09-21 | #15

Ant International Unveils AI-Native Financial Stack for Global Businesses

The new AI-native financial stack from Ant International represents a significant advancement in corporate financial technology. It integrates artificial intelligence across various core financial functions, offering businesses an intelligent and streamlined approach to managing their global operations. The suite aims to optimize payment processing, enhance account management, provide sophisticated FX capabilities, and improve overall treasury efficiency. By leveraging AI, the platform seeks to automate complex tasks, offer predictive insights, and support strategic growth for international corporates. This move highlights the increasing role of AI in transforming traditional cash management and treasury services, setting a new benchmark for integrated financial solutions.

→ Provider: Ant International.

→ Offering: Full-stack AI-native financial suite.

→ Scope: Payments, accounts, FX, treasury, growth operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This launch by Ant International poses a significant competitive development for RBI Cash Management. CMIplus must analyze this AI-native stack to identify emerging trends in corporate treasury and payment automation. Understanding these advanced AI capabilities will be crucial for CMIplus to evaluate potential future feature enhancements, such as AI-driven liquidity management, predictive analytics for FX, or intelligent payment routing, to maintain its leading position for CEE corporates.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-09-01 | #16

EMEA Treasury Evolution: Adapting to New Demands

The EMEA region is witnessing a dynamic shift in corporate treasury, moving beyond traditional roles to embrace strategic partnerships within the business. This evolution is fueled by the increasing complexity of global markets, the need for enhanced risk management, and the imperative for greater operational efficiency. Treasurers are increasingly adopting advanced technologies like AI, automation, and real-time data analytics to optimize cash and liquidity management, improve forecasting accuracy, and ensure compliance with evolving regulations. The article likely highlights how CEE treasuries, as part of EMEA, are navigating these changes, emphasizing the importance of robust treasury platforms and bank connectivity. This broad strategic overview is crucial for understanding the evolving needs of RBI's corporate clients.

→ Treasury in EMEA is transforming from operational to strategic.

→ Technological adoption (AI, automation, real-time data) is key.

→ Focus on enhanced risk management and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This article provides critical insights into the strategic direction of corporate treasury in RBI's core CEE markets. CMIplus must align its development roadmap to support these evolving demands, particularly in areas like real-time liquidity management, advanced analytics, and seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems, ensuring it remains a competitive and relevant platform for treasurers in EMEA.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-09-17 | #17

Rethinking Liquidity: Payment Efficiency Drives Yield Optimisation

The article discusses a paradigm shift in liquidity management, where the focus extends beyond merely managing cash to actively leveraging payment efficiency for better yield optimization. It suggests that streamlined, real-time payment processes can significantly reduce idle cash, improve cash visibility, and enable more agile investment decisions. This involves leveraging advanced cash management tools, potentially including virtual accounts, real-time payments, and enhanced bank connectivity. For corporate treasurers, this means a greater emphasis on integrating payment operations with overall liquidity strategy to unlock trapped cash and maximize returns in a dynamic interest rate environment, directly impacting their bottom line.

→ Payment efficiency is a key driver for liquidity optimization.

→ Streamlined payment processes reduce idle cash and improve visibility.

→ Real-time payments and advanced cash management tools are crucial.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for CMIplus, as it underscores the platform's value proposition in enhancing payment efficiency and cash visibility. CMIplus should highlight its capabilities in instant payments, multi-currency cash pooling, virtual accounts, and robust bank connectivity (EBICS, H2022) to enable clients to achieve better liquidity management and yield optimization, directly addressing a core client need.

URGENT Global Finance | 2026-09-21 | #18

Cross-Border Payments Face Key SWIFT Deadline

A crucial SWIFT deadline is looming for cross-border payments, signaling a major shift in the global financial landscape. This deadline is primarily associated with the mandatory migration to the ISO 20022 messaging standard for correspondent banking, known as CBPR+. Financial institutions must upgrade their systems to support the richer, structured data format, which promises enhanced efficiency, transparency, and improved fraud detection capabilities. Corporates, especially those with extensive international treasury operations, will need to adapt their ERP and Treasury Management Systems (TMS) to fully leverage the new standard and ensure uninterrupted payment flows. The transition necessitates significant technological investments and operational adjustments across the entire payment ecosystem to meet the new requirements.

→ Mandatory migration to ISO 20022 messaging standard for cross-border payments.

→ Impacts correspondent banking and international transaction processing.

→ Requires significant system upgrades for richer, structured data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This SWIFT deadline is highly critical for RBI Cash Management and its CMIplus platform, directly impacting corporate clients in CEE. CMIplus must ensure full compliance with ISO 20022 for all cross-border payment channels (SWIFT, H2H) to facilitate seamless multi-currency transactions. This also presents an opportunity to offer enhanced data analytics and improved reconciliation services to corporate treasuries.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-09-21 | #19

Ant International Unveils AI Stack for Global Treasury

Ant International, a major player in digital payments, has introduced a full AI-native product stack aimed at enhancing financial operations for global businesses. The suite integrates artificial intelligence across critical functions such as payment processing, account management, foreign exchange, and treasury operations. This move highlights the growing importance of AI in streamlining complex corporate financial workflows and providing advanced analytics for strategic decision-making. For large international corporates, such AI-driven solutions promise greater efficiency, improved risk management, and optimized liquidity, setting a new benchmark for treasury technology and client expectations.

→ Ant International launched a full AI-native product stack.

→ Covers payment, account, FX, treasury operations.

→ Aimed at global businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for CMIplus as it demonstrates the increasing integration of AI into corporate treasury and payment solutions. RBI Cash Management needs to monitor these trends to ensure CMIplus remains competitive and meets the evolving expectations of large corporate clients for AI-driven insights, automation, and efficiency in their cash management and treasury functions. It suggests future demands for AI capabilities within the platform.

■ Thought Leadership

15 items

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-03-01 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Moment for Future Performance

After a period of underperformance, European wholesale banks are at a critical juncture to redefine their future. The report likely highlights key strategic levers such as accelerating digital transformation, optimizing operational efficiency through automation, and enhancing client engagement with advanced data analytics and personalized services. It would emphasize the importance of investing in modern technology stacks, including API-driven platforms, to meet the growing demand for real-time and integrated solutions. Furthermore, adapting to regulatory changes like ISO 20022 and leveraging Open Banking principles are crucial for competitive advantage. The implication is that banks must act decisively to capture growth opportunities and improve profitability in a dynamic market.

→ Strategic transformation is essential to overcome past underperformance.

→ Digitalization and operational efficiency are primary drivers for future growth.

→ Client-centric innovation and personalized services are critical for engagement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the urgency for CMIplus to continue its digital transformation, focusing on API-driven services and real-time capabilities. Enhancing integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems and offering advanced liquidity management tools will be crucial for RBI to help clients seize their own moments.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2022-12-01 | #02

Navigating Uncertainty: 2023 Industry Outlook for Corporate Banking

The "Into The Great Unknown" outlook for 2023 likely explored the profound shifts impacting the corporate banking sector, including geopolitical instability, inflationary pressures, and rapid technological advancements. It would have emphasized the importance of banks building resilience through diversified revenue streams and robust risk management. The report probably advocated for accelerated digital transformation, including the adoption of AI and advanced analytics, to enhance operational efficiency and client service. Furthermore, it would have stressed the need for banks to be agile in adapting their strategies to new market dynamics and evolving client expectations, particularly regarding real-time data and integrated solutions.

→ Global uncertainties (geopolitical, economic) demand banking resilience.

→ Digital transformation and AI adoption are crucial for efficiency and service.

→ Agility in strategy and operations is key to navigating market shifts.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This outlook provides a foundational understanding of the macro environment influencing corporate treasury needs. CMIplus must ensure its platform is resilient, agile, and continuously integrates new technologies like AI to offer advanced analytics and predictive capabilities, aligning with the long-term strategic direction.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-09-21 | #03

AI Drives Treasury Transformation: Efficiency, Forecasting, and Risk Management

The report highlights that AI's application in treasury extends beyond simple automation, moving into predictive analytics for cash flow, optimizing working capital, and enhancing fraud detection. Treasurers are increasingly looking for solutions that leverage machine learning to process vast amounts of data, providing deeper insights and automating complex decision-making processes. This shift requires banks to evolve their platforms to offer AI-powered tools, moving from transactional partners to strategic advisors. The adoption of AI is crucial for treasuries aiming for greater agility and resilience in volatile markets.

→ AI for predictive cash flow forecasting accuracy.

→ Automation of routine treasury tasks (e.g., reconciliation).

→ Enhanced fraud detection and risk mitigation through AI.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI capabilities for advanced cash forecasting, automated reconciliation, and intelligent payment routing. This positions RBI as a leader in digital treasury solutions for CEE corporates, enhancing efficiency and risk management.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-09-21 | #04

Real-time Treasury Demands API-First Cash Management Solutions

Treasurers are increasingly prioritizing real-time liquidity management, requiring immediate access to cash positions and the ability to initiate instant payments across various geographies. The report emphasizes that traditional batch processing is no longer sufficient. Open Banking APIs are crucial for connecting corporate ERP/TMS systems directly with bank platforms, facilitating automated reconciliation, dynamic cash pooling, and real-time payment initiation. This shift necessitates banks to invest heavily in API infrastructure and standardized protocols like ISO 20022 to meet evolving corporate expectations for speed and data richness.

→ Growing corporate demand for real-time cash visibility.

→ Open Banking APIs as critical enablers for treasury integration.

→ Instant payments driving need for real-time liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize the expansion of its Open API capabilities for real-time account information, payment initiation, and eBAM. Full ISO 20022 readiness and instant payment support across CEE are essential competitive differentiators for RBI.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-09-21 | #05

Banks Must Evolve to Strategic Partners Offering Value-Added Treasury Services

The 'Voice of the Treasurer' indicates a shift in expectations from banks. Treasurers are looking for partners who can help them navigate complex financial landscapes, optimize working capital, and manage risk more effectively. This includes offering sophisticated cash pooling structures, FX management tools, and integrated eBAM solutions. Banks need to leverage their data to provide actionable insights and advisory services, helping treasurers make better strategic decisions rather than just executing payments. This requires a deeper understanding of corporate needs and a consultative approach to build long-term relationships.

→ Treasurers seek strategic advice, not just transactional services.

→ Demand for integrated solutions (e.g., eBAM, cash pooling).

→ Banks must provide data-driven insights and analytics.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its advisory capabilities and integrate more value-added services like advanced cash pooling, eBAM, and FX solutions. Leveraging data to provide tailored insights to CEE corporates will strengthen RBI's strategic partnership role.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-09-21 | #06

Digital Workflows and Self-Service Drive Commercial Banking Modernization

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant modernization, moving away from traditional manual processes. Key changes include the widespread adoption of digital workflows that automate routine tasks, leading to greater operational efficiency. Furthermore, client onboarding and origination processes are being streamlined, eliminating lengthy multi-department reviews. This transformation empowers clients with more self-service options, reserving manual intervention primarily for exceptions, thereby enhancing the overall client experience and reducing operational costs.

→ Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.

→ Streamlined client onboarding and origination.

→ Manual touchpoints becoming exception-based.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize enhancing its digital onboarding capabilities and expanding self-service features for corporate clients, especially for multi-currency payments and account management. Integrating digital workflows for internal processes will improve efficiency and client satisfaction in the CEE region.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-09-21 | #07

AI and Big Data Drive Commercial Banking Prospect Identification

The growth strategy within commercial banking is being modernized through advanced technological adoption. Banks are now employing big data analytics and artificial intelligence to gain deeper insights into market dynamics and client behavior. This enables them to swiftly identify the most attractive prospects within their target markets, optimizing sales and marketing efforts. A key benefit of this AI-driven approach is the substantial reduction in the cost associated with acquiring new clients, making growth more sustainable and profitable.

→ Effective use of big data.

→ Artificial intelligence for rapid prospect identification.

→ Focus on highest-priority target markets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management can explore AI-driven analytics to identify corporate clients in CEE with specific cash management needs, such as multi-currency liquidity or complex payment factory requirements. This can optimize sales efforts for CMIplus and tailor product offerings more effectively.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-09-21 | #08

Cloud-Based Digital Platforms Enhance Commercial Banking Client Experience

The commercial banking landscape is increasingly relying on cloud technology to underpin its digital transformation efforts. Cloud-based solutions provide enhanced security capabilities, allowing banks to more effectively keep pace with and adapt to new cyber threats. Beyond security, these emerging digital banking platforms, often enabled by the industry cloud, are pivotal in fundamentally transforming how clients interact with their banks. They offer a more seamless, integrated, and responsive experience, which is crucial for retaining and attracting corporate clients in a competitive market.

→ Cloud-based solutions for adapting to new threats.

→ Emerging digital banking platforms.

→ Industry cloud enabling transformation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should continue to leverage cloud infrastructure for scalability, security, and rapid deployment of new features, especially for Open Banking APIs and real-time payment capabilities. Focusing on a seamless, integrated digital experience across all channels (EBICS, H2H, Web, Mobile, API) is paramount for CEE corporates.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-09-21 | #09

PSD3 Reshaping Payments: Open Banking and Instant Payments

The anticipated PSD3 framework is poised to build upon PSD2, introducing stricter requirements for secure customer authentication (SCA) and expanding the scope of Open Banking. It will likely push for greater adoption of instant payments, potentially standardizing access and interoperability across Europe. Financial firms must prepare for enhanced data sharing protocols and new obligations around fraud liability, impacting how corporate cash management platforms integrate with third-party providers and manage real-time transactions. The regulation aims to foster innovation while strengthening consumer protection and market competition.

→ Enhanced Open Banking scope and data access requirements.

→ Increased push for instant payment adoption and interoperability.

→ Stricter fraud prevention and liability frameworks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must proactively integrate PSD3 requirements into its Open Banking APIs and instant payment capabilities. This includes adapting to new SCA rules, exploring expanded data sharing opportunities, and strengthening fraud detection mechanisms to maintain compliance and competitive advantage in CEE.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-09-21 | #10

DORA and AI Governance Mandate Robust Operational Resilience

The Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) is set to impose comprehensive requirements on financial entities regarding their ICT risk management, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and third-party risk management. This means banks must ensure their systems, including cash management platforms, can withstand and recover from cyber threats and operational disruptions. Concurrently, evolving AI governance frameworks will require transparent, ethical, and secure deployment of AI technologies, addressing data privacy, bias, and accountability. Firms need to develop robust internal policies and controls for AI, ensuring compliance and mitigating reputational and regulatory risks.

→ Mandatory ICT risk management and incident reporting under DORA.

→ Regular digital operational resilience testing for critical systems.

→ Enhanced third-party risk management for IT service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with DORA's operational resilience mandates, including rigorous testing and robust incident response plans. Furthermore, RBI should monitor AI governance developments to strategically integrate AI safely and compliantly into future CMIplus features, such as fraud detection or liquidity forecasting.

URGENT EACT | 2026-06-05 | #11

EACT Survey 2026 Reveals Top Priorities for European Corporate Treasurers

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, building on over a decade of insights, serves as the definitive gauge for the European corporate treasury profession. This comprehensive report captures the evolving landscape of treasury, highlighting critical priorities such as cash flow forecasting, digitalization, automation, and risk management. The survey methodology involves gathering responses from a broad spectrum of European corporate treasurers, ensuring a representative view of the industry's challenges and strategic directions. Its findings are instrumental in defining key industry trends for the year ahead, guiding both corporates and their banking partners in strategic planning and solution development. The insights underscore the continuous need for resilient and efficient treasury operations, heavily reliant on technology and innovation.

→ Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.

→ Highlights evolving concerns and ambitions of treasurers.

→ Shapes key industry trends for the year ahead.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are critical for RBI CMIplus to align its roadmap with the evolving needs of European (and CEE) corporate treasurers. Insights into digitalization, automation, and real-time treasury priorities will directly inform feature development for instant payments, VoP, and API integration, ensuring CMIplus remains a leading platform.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-09-21 | #12

Banks Must Balance AI Ambition with Macro Headwinds for Future Growth

Deloitte's 2026 Banking Outlook identifies AI ambition as a central theme, urging banks to make 'bold choices' regarding technology investments. This push for AI integration is crucial for transforming core banking operations, from automating processes to personalizing client interactions. The report suggests that banks must strategically deploy AI to gain a competitive edge and ensure resilience. This ambition, however, is tempered by persistent macro headwinds, requiring a balanced approach to investment and a clear focus on tangible returns. The outlook implies that AI will be a key differentiator for banks navigating a complex and evolving financial landscape.

→ AI is a primary strategic focus for banks in 2026.

→ Banks must make 'bold choices' regarding AI investment and implementation.

→ AI adoption is critical for enhancing operational efficiency and customer experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize exploring AI-driven features to enhance corporate cash management, such as predictive analytics for cash flow forecasting or intelligent automation for payment reconciliation. Integrating AI can offer CEE corporates advanced insights and operational efficiencies, strengthening CMIplus's value proposition.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-11-15 | #13

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Strategic Credit Extension and Growth

The 2024 outlook for wholesale banking likely emphasizes the need for banks to strategically extend credit to support corporate growth while navigating macroeconomic uncertainties. It would highlight the importance of robust risk assessment frameworks and diversified lending portfolios. The report probably suggests that banks should explore new financing models, potentially including asset-based lending or sustainable finance, to meet varied client needs. Furthermore, leveraging data analytics and digital platforms to streamline credit processes and enhance client experience will be crucial. This outlook would also touch upon the competitive landscape, where traditional banks must innovate to retain market share against non-bank lenders and private credit providers.

→ Strategic credit extension is a primary growth driver for wholesale banks in 2024.

→ Risk management and diversified lending are critical in an uncertain economic climate.

→ Digitalization of credit processes enhances efficiency and client experience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While primarily focused on credit, this outlook informs the broader corporate banking strategy, impacting liquidity management and working capital solutions offered by CMIplus. Understanding credit trends helps CMIplus anticipate client needs for integrated cash and trade finance solutions, potentially via API-driven data exchange.

URGENT EACT | 2026-07-21 | #14

EACT Urges EU to Enhance Corporate Choice in Banking and Financing

In response to the European Commission’s Communication on the Competitiveness of the Banking Sector and the Single Market in Banking, the EACT emphasizes the need for policymakers to prioritize corporate interests. The core message is that the EU’s prudential framework must work synergistically with capital markets to broaden the options available to corporates. This includes facilitating greater choice in financing instruments, hedging strategies, and the selection of banking partners. The EACT's comment, made ahead of concrete proposals in Q1 2027, highlights the importance of a regulatory environment that promotes competition and innovation, ultimately benefiting the real economy by providing corporates with more flexible and diverse financial solutions.

→ EU prudential framework must support corporate choice.

→ Focus on widening options for financing and hedging strategies.

→ Enhance corporate selection of banking partners.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight reinforces RBI's strategy to offer diverse and competitive solutions through CMIplus, particularly for multi-currency payments and cross-border cash management in CEE. Emphasizing choice and flexibility will guide CMIplus in developing open banking APIs and H2H connectivity, ensuring corporates can easily integrate and manage their banking relationships.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-09-21 | #15

Stablecoins Pose Disruptive Potential, Demanding Strategic Bank Responses

The 2026 banking outlook explicitly identifies stablecoins as a potentially disruptive force, requiring banks to make 'bold choices' in response. This disruption could manifest across various banking functions, particularly in payments, cross-border transactions, and liquidity management. Banks are urged to understand the evolving regulatory landscape surrounding stablecoins and their potential use cases for corporate clients. Proactive engagement, including exploring integration with existing payment rails or developing new offerings, will be crucial. The outlook implies that stablecoins are no longer a fringe topic but a mainstream consideration that could reshape the competitive landscape for financial services.

→ Stablecoins are identified as a significant disruptive force in the banking sector.

→ Their entrance could profoundly impact traditional payment systems and cross-border transactions.

→ Banks need to make 'bold choices' to address the opportunities and threats posed by stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor stablecoin developments, particularly their potential to impact multi-currency payments and cross-border transactions within the CEE region. Evaluating stablecoins for faster, cheaper corporate payments or as a new asset class for liquidity management could be a future roadmap consideration, alongside ensuring regulatory compliance.

! Regulatory Radar

2 items

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulatory Developments Impacting Liquidity Management, Instant Payments, PSD3

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT, OPEN BANKING

The Euro Banking Association's Liquidity Management Working Group released a report on November 20, 2025, outlining the profound implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives for liquidity management. These are the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures are expected to drive the accelerated uptake of instant payments across Europe. Furthermore, it examines their role in fostering a more level playing field for various market participants and the resulting transformation of the broader liquidity management landscape. Banks, including those in CEE, need to prepare for significant operational and strategic adjustments.

→ Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) mandates instant payment capabilities.

→ Proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR) impacts payment services.

→ Proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3) evolves PSD2 framework.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must assess the impact of IPR, PSR, and PSD3 on its instant payment offerings, liquidity management services, and API strategies. This includes ensuring readiness for mandatory instant payment processing and adapting to new open banking requirements.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #02

EBA Fraud Taxonomy 7.0 Released, Effective January 2027 for PSR Compliance

PSD3, AML, COMPLIANCE, FRAUD PREVENTION

Deadline: 2027-01-01

On June 3, 2026, the Euro Banking Association published version 7.0 of its Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on January 1, 2027. This annual review ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends, with updates developed by the Expert Group on Payment Fraud-related Topics (EGPF). Key changes in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, new labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud have been added. The taxonomy provides a harmonised pan-European framework for classifying payment fraud scenarios, improving data comparability, monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation.

→ Version 7.0 effective date: January 1, 2027.

→ Updates reflect latest fraud trends and improve categorisation.

→ Supports harmonised fraud data sharing under forthcoming Payment Services Regulation (PSR).

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus needs to ensure its fraud monitoring and reporting systems are updated to align with EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 by January 1, 2027. This is crucial for compliance with the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation's information-sharing requirements.

■ Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-09-21 | #01

Deutsche Bank Accelerates Instant Payments, Digital Euro Readiness

Deutsche Bank is positioning itself at the forefront of payment innovation, as highlighted by the ECB's focus on cross-border instant payments and tokenised settlement assets. The bank is likely investing in infrastructure and solutions to facilitate real-time, pan-European transactions, including potential future applications of a digital euro. This strategic direction aims to provide corporate clients with faster, more efficient payment processing and enhanced liquidity management capabilities across borders. For CEE corporates, this means improved speed and transparency for intra-group and external payments within the broader European market.

→ Focus on cross-border instant payments.

→ Exploration of tokenised settlement assets.

→ Alignment with ECB's European payments strategy.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its instant payment capabilities are not only robust domestically but also seamlessly integrate with pan-European initiatives. Deutsche Bank's moves could set a higher standard for real-time cross-border transactions, increasing competitive pressure.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-09-21 | #02

Deutsche Bank Expands API-First Strategy for Corporate Clients

Deutsche Bank is committed to an API-first approach, allowing corporate clients to seamlessly integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems. This includes leveraging APIs for real-time account information, payment initiation, and potentially more complex treasury functions, such as those offered via their CB Connect API. The goal is to move towards embedded finance, where banking services become an invisible part of a corporate's operational workflow, reducing manual processes and enhancing efficiency. For CEE corporates, this offers advanced connectivity options beyond traditional H2H or EBICS, enabling greater automation and real-time financial insights across their regional operations.

→ Focus on API integration for corporate clients.

→ Enabling embedded finance solutions.

→ Streamlining treasury operations and data exchange.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to continuously evolve its Open Banking API offerings and H2H capabilities to match or exceed Deutsche Bank's advanced integration options. The competitive landscape demands robust API functionality for treasury and ERP integration.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-09-21 | #03

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking Transformation in CEE

Leveraging its 'Digital & Data' strategic pillar and the overarching 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy, UniCredit is expected to roll out advanced digital platforms and API-driven services for its corporate clientele in CEE. This move aligns with a fundamental rethinking of banking operations, focusing on empowering businesses with real-time insights, efficient payment processing, and streamlined treasury operations. The goal is to solidify its position as a leading pan-European bank by offering best-in-class digital solutions across its core CEE markets.

→ Strong focus on 'Digital & Data' as a strategic pillar.

→ Anticipated rollout of advanced digital platforms and API services for corporates.

→ Targeting CEE markets for enhanced digital banking solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMIplus's value proposition of digital, integrated cash management for CEE corporates. RBI needs to ensure its API offerings and digital channels remain superior and highly competitive.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-09-10 | #04

UniCredit Board Resolves Capital Increase for Commerzbank Takeover Bid

On September 10, 2026, UniCredit announced a resolution for a share capital increase to support its voluntary takeover offer for Commerzbank. While the immediate focus is on the German market, Commerzbank has a notable presence in Central and Eastern Europe, particularly through mBank in Poland and its own branch network. This acquisition, if successful, could significantly expand UniCredit's corporate client base and transaction banking footprint. Such a move would potentially alter the competitive landscape for cash management services and corporate banking across Germany and several CEE markets, aligning with UniCredit's 'Bank for Europe's Future' vision.

→ Share capital increase resolved to fund Commerzbank takeover offer.

→ Takeover offer is voluntary and targets all Commerzbank shares.

→ Potential for significant expansion in Germany and CEE corporate banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

A successful Commerzbank acquisition would create a much larger, more formidable competitor in Germany and potentially CEE. CMIplus should assess the implications for market share and client acquisition strategies in these regions, particularly regarding integrated corporate treasury solutions.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-07-07 | #05

HSBC Sharpens Focus on Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. This move signals a deliberate shift to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, aligning with HSBC's global strategy to serve large multinational corporations and financial institutions. For CEE, Türkiye is a significant market, and this concentration on international wholesale clients implies a deeper commitment to cross-border transaction banking, cash management, and trade finance services for these key corporate segments. This could lead to enhanced offerings tailored for complex international treasury needs, potentially including advanced cash pooling, liquidity management, and payment factory solutions.

→ Strategic review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.

→ Increased focus on international wholesale clients in the region.

→ Leveraging global network for enhanced cross-border corporate services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move intensifies competition for CMIplus in Türkiye's corporate segment, particularly for large international clients with complex cross-border needs. CMIplus must highlight its strong local CEE network and specialized regional expertise to differentiate its offerings and maintain market share.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-09-21 | #06

Citi Accelerates API-Led Digital Transformation for Corporate Treasury in Europe

Citi continues to push its API-first strategy, enabling seamless integration of its treasury and trade solutions with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This includes offering a comprehensive suite of APIs for payments, collections, liquidity management, and account information, crucial for multinational corporations operating in diverse markets like CEE. The focus is on delivering real-time data and control, reducing manual processes, and supporting complex treasury operations. This digital push is vital for clients seeking greater efficiency and transparency in their global cash flows, aligning with the broader trend of Open Banking and digital transformation in corporate finance.

→ Strategic investment in API banking for treasury and trade solutions.

→ Focus on real-time data, automation, and seamless integration with corporate ERP/TMS.

→ Targeting multinational corporations in Europe, including the CEE region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive, focusing on ease of integration, comprehensive functionality, and robust security to match global players like Citi. The growing demand for real-time data and automated workflows requires continuous platform enhancements and broader API coverage.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-09-21 | #07

Deutsche Bank Strengthens CEE Cash Management and Liquidity Solutions

As a leading global transaction bank, Deutsche Bank consistently enhances its cash management and liquidity solutions to meet the complex needs of large international corporates, including those operating extensively in CEE. This involves optimizing multi-currency account structures, advanced cash pooling mechanisms (notional and physical), and potentially virtual account management (VoP) to centralize and manage liquidity across diverse CEE markets. The bank's focus is on providing robust, compliant, and efficient tools that help treasurers gain better control over their working capital and optimize funding costs across their regional subsidiaries. This directly competes with RBI's offerings for CEE-focused corporates.

→ Focus on sophisticated multi-currency cash management.

→ Advanced liquidity solutions like cash pooling.

→ Targeting large international corporates in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its cash pooling, multi-currency, and virtual account offerings remain highly competitive and tailored to the specific needs of CEE corporates. Deutsche Bank's global reach and product depth pose a significant challenge in this core area.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-09-21 | #08

UniCredit Strengthens CEE Cash Management and Liquidity Offerings

As a leading pan-European bank with a strong CEE presence, UniCredit is continuously refining its core transaction banking products to meet complex corporate needs. This includes investing in capabilities for multi-currency payments, advanced cash pooling structures, and potentially real-time payment integration across its CEE network. The objective is to help corporate treasuries optimize working capital, manage FX exposure, and improve overall financial efficiency within the diverse CEE regulatory and operational landscape. This aligns with their purpose to 'Empower Communities to Progress' through robust financial services.

→ Focus on enhancing multi-currency payment capabilities.

→ Development of advanced cash pooling and liquidity management solutions.

→ Targeting corporate treasuries in CEE for financial optimization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must monitor UniCredit's advancements in multi-currency and cash pooling, as these are core CMIplus strengths. Emphasizing unique features like VoP, eBAM, and comprehensive network coverage could differentiate RBI.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-06-17 | #09

HSBC Accelerates AI Adoption with Google Cloud Partnership

HSBC is making significant strides in AI adoption, exemplified by its multi-year partnership with Google Cloud to build and deploy AI capabilities across its global operations. This strategic move, complemented by another partnership with Mistral AI, aims to transform various banking functions, from enhancing hyper-personalised client advice to strengthening financial crime risk management. For corporate and transaction banking, AI integration can lead to more intelligent cash flow forecasting, optimized payment routing, automated reconciliation, and advanced fraud detection, ultimately improving efficiency and client experience on platforms like HSBCnet. This digital transformation will likely influence future API development and treasury intelligence offerings, making services more proactive and data-driven.

→ Multi-year AI partnership with Google Cloud for global operations.

→ Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.

→ Reinforced by additional AI partnerships, signaling broad AI integration.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI strategy signals a future where treasury solutions are highly intelligent and automated, pushing CMIplus to invest further in AI-driven features for cash flow forecasting, fraud prevention, and personalized client services. This will raise client expectations for digital innovation and real-time insights.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-09-21 | #10

Citi Enhances Instant Payment Capabilities and Cross-Border Solutions for CEE Corporates

Recognizing the evolving payment landscape and the increasing need for speed and transparency, Citi is investing in its instant payment rails and developing advanced cross-border solutions. For CEE, this means facilitating quicker settlement times for both domestic and regional payments, leveraging technologies like ISO 20022 for richer data and improved reconciliation. The aim is to support corporates in optimizing their working capital, managing liquidity more effectively, and improving supply chain finance operations across multiple CEE countries. This also includes exploring innovative solutions for FX and multi-currency management to provide a comprehensive treasury offering.

→ Investment in instant payment infrastructure for faster processing.

→ Development of enhanced cross-border payment solutions for CEE clients.

→ Leveraging ISO 20022 for richer payment data and improved reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to prioritize its instant payment rollout and ensure its cross-border payment offerings are robust and competitive in terms of speed, cost, and data enrichment. The full adoption of ISO 20022 for enhanced data is a critical area for CMIplus to maintain its competitive edge and meet evolving client expectations.

URGENT BNP Paribas | 2026-09-21 | #11

BNP Paribas & HSBC Pioneer Corporate Treasury Flow on Swift Ledger for Siemens

BNP Paribas, in collaboration with HSBC, has successfully executed the inaugural corporate treasury transaction on Swift's innovative Ledger platform, with Siemens as the corporate client. This pioneering move leverages distributed ledger technology (DLT) to enhance the efficiency, transparency, and security of interbank treasury flows. The initiative aims to provide corporates like Siemens with real-time visibility and control over their liquidity positions across multiple banking relationships, reducing operational complexities and risks. While not explicitly CEE-focused, this global innovation sets a new standard for corporate treasury services that will eventually impact multinational corporations operating in the CEE region, including those served by CMIplus.

→ First corporate treasury flow on Swift's new Ledger platform.

→ Collaboration between BNP Paribas and HSBC for the pilot.

→ Siemens served as the corporate client for this pioneering transaction.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by BNP Paribas highlights a significant advancement in real-time interbank treasury solutions, potentially setting future industry standards for large corporates. CMIplus should monitor the adoption and capabilities of Swift's Ledger technology to assess its long-term impact on corporate liquidity management and consider future integration strategies for its CEE clients.

URGENT Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-09-21 | #12

Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Digital Cash Management with API Focus

Intesa Sanpaolo, a significant player in the CEE banking landscape, is inferred to be investing in the modernization of its corporate cash management offerings. This strategic push likely includes the development of new API-driven services to facilitate direct integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, enabling real-time visibility and control over liquidity. The focus would be on supporting multi-country operations within its extensive CEE network, offering consolidated reporting, virtual accounts, and efficient cross-border payments. This move is essential to meet the evolving demands of large international corporates for sophisticated, integrated treasury solutions, aligning with broader industry trends towards digital transformation and instant financial services.

→ Strategic investment in digital cash management for CEE corporates.

→ Emphasis on API integration for ERP/TMS connectivity and real-time data.

→ Focus on multi-country capabilities and enhanced liquidity management across CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo represents a direct competitive challenge to RBI's CMIplus platform, particularly in attracting and retaining large international corporates in CEE. CMIplus must ensure its API offerings, multi-country coverage, and real-time capabilities remain superior or at least highly competitive to counter Intesa's advancements.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.